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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Judy Hinchey (shown with Clover) said she hopes to establish a miniature horse therapy practice.

## A little problem — or a big one

Newton woman fights to keep her mini horse but neighbors smell trouble

By Camilo Fonseca  
GLOBE STAFF

Newton has its fair share of neighborhood spats — headaches over leaf blowers, over-night parking bans, and tricolored street lines, to name a few. But its latest flare-up is a bit smaller.

To be precise, miniature-horse-sized. A longtime resident is fighting for the right to keep her mini horse in the backyard of her Auburndale home. Judy Hinchey hopes city officials will allow her to keep Clover, slightly larger than her black Labrador, in her yard, despite zoning questions and neighbors' complaints about manure odor. "I don't want it to be in a boarding place

that's 45 minutes away," Hinchey said. "We have to bond. We're a therapy team . . . that's why I want her here with me."

Newton officials originally denied her request for a license to keep Clover, as her property wasn't large enough to meet requirements that her facilities have to be a certain distance from neighbors. She appealed, and on Wednesday the Newton public health board heard her request.

The board said it would issue a ruling at a later date.

Clover has plenty of fans. Dozens of people have left messages on a local Auburndale Facebook group, urging the city to reconsider its initial decision to deny

Hinchey's application.

"When people have the opportunity to meet Clover, they're pretty much smitten," said Newton resident Nancy Horwitz.

Bruce Kwartler, another resident, said Hinchey had been "trying to do things the right way from the very beginning."

"That should be taken into account," he said.

Several residents appeared at the hearing in City Hall Wednesday, but the board declined to open the proceeding to public comment.

City officials said neighbors have complained about the smell of manure, as well as

CLOVER, Page A10

## Healey, team at odds on ballot question

She hails conservation measure but booklet says it would cost

By Chris Van Buskirk  
GLOBE STAFF

As she stood at Chestnut Hill's Hammond Pond Trailhead in late August, Governor Maura Healey wondered what she could do "to make the world a better place."

In her estimation, endorsing a ballot question this November to dedicate a portion of state sales taxes to natural resource conservation was one answer.

"We can make sure that we are using taxpayer dollars wisely," Healey said at the campaign event for

the ballot measure, "in a way that makes sense."

But to hear it from Healey's own bean-counters, it may not be so simple.

The governor's budget office warned in voter booklets the state started sending to residents last week that the measure, listed as Question 6 on the ballot, could have a significant impact on state and local finances by automatically diverting tens of millions of dollars that currently help fund the state's annual budget into a new conservation

fund.

If passed, the measure could also carry "substantial," if not yet totally clear, costs to implement it.

The Healey administration's own assessment of the ballot question lands amid a wave of financial uncertainty on Beacon Hill, fueled in part by an ongoing fight over the Trump administration's attempts to carve away billions of dollars in funding from Massachusetts.

The apparent split between Healey and her budget office — which is

HEALEY, Page A7

## Gaining elsewhere, democratic socialists struggle to capitalize here

By Anjali Huynh  
GLOBE STAFF

Democratic socialists are having a moment, racking up primary wins in competitive states and fueling dreams that one of their own could ascend to the presidency.

It's a train democratic socialists in Massachusetts, regarded as a bastion of left-leaning politics, were happy to hop on. "For decades, socialists were irrelevant," the Boston DSA chapter proclaimed in a June Instagram post. "Then, we started winning."

But winning isn't exactly what they've been

doing here.

The Boston DSA, which, at more than 3,100 members, is among the country's largest chapters, endorsed just one candidate this primary cycle: Evan MacKay, a Cambridge labor organizer who lost their state legislative bid. The group opted not to back three other democratic socialists it had previously endorsed — all of whom ultimately won their primaries.

All the while, the chapter collected more than 5,000 signatures to put a rent control proposal on the ballot — only for the state's highest court

DEMOCRATIC SOCIALISTS, Page A6



CARLIN STIEHL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE 2022

Rep. Erika Uytendaele won a crowded Democratic primary for a state Senate seat. She wasn't endorsed by the DSA.

## Police use of AI social media tool questioned

Boston councilors see potential for misuse, say they should have been told

By Yogev Toby  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Meet the Instagram follower that may never stop looking at your feed: the Boston Police Department.

The department this summer started using new artificial intelligence software that combs through social media looking for possible threats and information helpful to investigations, a city report revealed this week.

The software, dubbed LifeRaft, offers tools to scrape troves of data from public social media posts. Officers can query the data using keywords and geography-based searches, such as people's names, phone numbers, and social media handles. The department gained access to the software in June, according to the city's 2025 Surveillance Technology Report released Monday.

Such technologies are common among law enforcement agencies in the country, as violent threats and hate groups increasingly find a home in online chatrooms and hidden corners of the dark web. But critics of these tools say they can also be used to target individuals based on speech or political ideologies.

LIFERAFT, Page A10

## Despite Trump, Fed raises rates 1st time in years

President's choice for chair says inflation is 'too high'

By Colby Smith  
NEW YORK TIMES

The Federal Reserve raised interest rates by a quarter of a percentage point on Wednesday, the first increase in more than three years and a significant step by Kevin Warsh, the central bank's chair, to combat elevated inflation.

The decision, which lifts rates to a new range of 3.75 percent to 4 percent, was supported by all 12 members of the Federal Open Market Committee.

"The plain fact is that inflation is too high and has been for too long," Warsh said at a news conference after the decision was announced. He added that the US economy remained strong and unemployment was low, justifying the Fed removing

FED, Page A7

**Brockton Mayor Moises M. Rodriguez is now facing a charge of assault and battery** for allegedly touching a 17-year-old girl during a city parade. **B1.**

**The Trump administration has approved a \$2.8 billion sale of bombs to Israel,** in what would be among the largest deliveries of US munitions there. **A3.**

**The rapper Macklemore and Patriots owner Robert Kraft each pledged major contributions toward aid for Palestinians,** the latest turn in a controversy over the rapper's removal from Ed Sheeran's tour. **B2.**

Drop, bye

**Thursday:** Showers, humid. High 74-79. Low 65-70.

**Friday:** Drier, pleasant. High 76-81. Low 52-57.

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